reactions are particularly likely given India and China's checkered history,[21] and past Sino-Indian tension over Indian nuclear capabilities.[22]

Missile defense, then, could have significantly destabilizing effects in South Asia, creating incentives for costly arms races and possibly increasing the likelihood that states will be tempted to strike first with nuclear weapons during a crisis. Thus, despite BMD's appeal to Indian political leaders and some regional analysts, we believe that India should forgo a missile defense capability. It would do better to concentrate on increasing the security and viability of its own arsenal, rather than taking steps that could potentially threaten the nuclear forces of its adversaries.

Below, we raise a final issue: the state of the South Asian security environment in the wake of the November 2008 Mumbai terror attacks.

SOUTH ASIA'S SORCERER'S APPRENTICE PROBLEM

On November 26, 2008, a group of ten terrorists attacked the city of Mumbai. Over the next three days, they went on a killing spree at a Jewish cultural center known as the Nariman House, the Oberoi-Trident and Taj Mahal hotels, the nearby Leopold Café, the Chhatrapati Shivaji railway terminus, and the Bhikaji Cama Children's Hospital.[23] By the time Indian police and paramilitary forces finally overpowered them, the terrorists had killed more than 160 people and wounded hundreds more.[24] Indian authorities ascertained that the terrorists were members of a long-banned but nonetheless active Pakistan-based terrorist organization, the Lashkar-e-Toiba.[25] Western governments subsequently supported New Delhi's conclusions, and the United Nations levied sanctions against LeT's parent organization, Jamaat-ud-Dawa, declaring it a terrorist entity.[26] The Mumbai assault became the latest in a series of attacks on Indian cities conducted by terror groups operating within Pakistan.[27]

Following these events, a single question reverberated from New Delhi to Washington: Were the Mumbai attacks not simply the work